



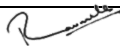
HIGHER HEALTH

2024

POLICY ON ADMISSIONS



Policy on Admissions

Approved by	Higher Health Board
Signed on behalf of the Board:	Prof R Ahluwalia
Signature	
Approval Date	20 March 2024
Effective Date	21 March 2024
Date of next Review	20 March 2027

Version Number	01
Version Date	March 2024
Author	Nireen Naidoo
Designation	Executive Manager: Office of the CEO
Reviewed by	EXCO
Review Date	March 2024

Table of Contents

Glossary	3
1. Background	5
2. Purpose.....	5
3. Legislative and Regulatory Framework.....	5
4. Scope and Application	6
5. Policy Principles	6
6. Roles and Responsibilities	6

Glossary

“Assessment” means the process used to identify, gather and interpret information against the required competencies in a qualification, part-qualification or skills programme in order to make a judgement about a learner’s achievement.

“Certificate” means a document indicating formal recognition by the QCTO of an occupational qualification, part qualification, (including legacy trades) or skills programme awarded to a successful learner.

“Curriculum” for the purposes of this Policy means requirements for learner achievement of a qualification or part-qualification in terms of knowledge, skills, and where relevant, work experience.

“e-learning” means a mode of teaching and learning that makes use of technology-mediated features.

“ Final Integrated Supervised Assessment” (FISA) means a supervised final assessment for which assessment processes, tools, and results are recorded towards the achievement of an occupational skills programme, conducted under examination conditions.

“Learner” is an inclusive term referring to anyone learning, including pupils, students, apprentices, interns, learners in learnerships, people doing training, and people learning non-formally and informally as well as people enrolled for particular qualifications or part-qualifications, and people learning in contact, distance, and self-study contexts at all levels in the system.

“National Qualifications Framework (NQF)” is a comprehensive system approved by the Minister of Higher Education and Training for the classification, registration, publication and articulation of quality assured national qualifications.

“NQF Act” means the South African National Qualifications Framework (NQF) Act No. 67 of 2008.

“NQF Level” means one of the series of levels of learning achievement arranged in ascending order from one to ten according to which the NQF is organised and to which qualification types are pegged.

“Occupational Qualifications Sub-Framework (OQSF)” means the sub-framework of qualifications developed and managed by the Quality Council for Trades and Occupations (QCTO).

“Quality Council for Trades and Occupations (QCTO)” means the Quality Council for Trades and Occupations established in terms of the NQF Act No. 67 of 2008, as amended, which is mandated to achieve the objectives of the NQF and to develop and manage the OQSF.

“Skills programme” means a programme that is occupationally based and when completed will constitute/contribute a credit towards a qualification registered on the NQF, according to Chapter 5 of the SDA.

1. Background

Higher Health is a non-profit organisation focused on the health and wellness of the youth in the post-school education and training (PSET) sector. Higher Health's model of delivering health and wellness services is to empower PSET learners to take charge of their health and wellness, through education and knowledge. Higher Health developed its e-learning Civic and Soft Skills Programme, which the QCTO accredited as a NQF Level 5 Skills Programme. All modules are inter-connected, with good citizenship underpinning the learning. The content also focuses on being good global citizens, so sustainable development goals (SDGs) feature in all the modules, and culminate in a separate module on climate change and action.

With the Civic and Soft Skills Programme, Higher Health aims to produce good national and global citizens who are empowered to take responsibility for their own health and wellbeing, who know how to assist others because of their new knowledge and skills, and who are equipped with soft skills designed for the job market.

The main target for the Civic and Soft Skills Programme are students and staff of the post-school education and training (PSET) sector in South Africa. However, other sectors have also shown an interest in this programme, and with political buy-in, may adopt it. These sectors include the youth not in education or training (NEET), and unemployed individuals currently receiving social grants. Service providers such as campus security and residence owners/managers who interact with students at PSET institutions are also good candidates for the Civic and Soft Skills Programme.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to describe Higher Health's approach to the admission of learners onto its Civic and Soft Skills Programme.

3. Legislative and Regulatory Framework

This policy must be read in conjunction with Higher Health's policies on:

- i. Assessment;
- ii. Tuition; and
- iii. Certification.

4. Scope and Application

- a. This policy applies to all learners who have applied for entrance to Higher Health's skills programme that is accredited as such by the Quality Council on Trades and Occupations (QCTO).
- b. This policy highlights Higher Health's admission criteria for the accredited Civic and Soft Skills Programme.

5. Policy Principles

- a. Selection and admissions decisions need to balance adherence to the principles of equity, inclusivity and diversity.
- b. Admissions practices are fair and transparent.
- c. Access to the programme is independent of the success in school- leaving examinations for identifying potential candidates from disadvantaged groups and socio- economically deprived backgrounds.
- d. Higher Health provides a teaching and learning environment that is conducive to success.
- e. Since teaching and learning takes place on an e-learning platform, there is no limit to the number of learners that can access the platform at any given time.
- f. The choice of cohorts of learners will be determined by the funding secured for a particular cohort – i.e. donors may specify the criteria for admission to the programme.
- g. Learners who are self-funded may enrol onto the programme, on condition that they have met the entry requirement.
- h. Learners wishing to enrol must have at least a NQF Level 1 qualification, which is equivalent to Grade 9 according to the Department of Basic Education; or NQF Level 1 occupational qualification, in terms of the QCTO; or must be registered at a PSET institution.
- i. Applications from learners who do not meet the criteria in (h) above, will be considered on a case-by-case basis.
- j. Special accommodation will be made for learners with disabilities such as sight or hearing.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

- a. The enrolment of learners is managed through the Curriculum unit, under the Director of Operations.
- b. Learners who are self-funded, may apply directly to Higher Health via its website, or email info@higherhealth.ac.za
- c. The Higher Health team will recruit and/or enrol learners for specific cohorts that are funded through specific donors, according to the admission criteria of that donor.
- d. Once recruited and enrolled, learners will be invited to attend an orientation session.
- e. Learner support is provided via the e-learning platform, by the Curriculum team.
- f. The learner will receive a certificate of participation for each module completed, which includes all compulsory activities and assessments.

- g. The learner must have successfully completed all modules, and received all module certificates of participation, before enrolling for the QCTO-approved FISA assessment.
- h. The final certificate of completion will be issued after successfully completing the QCTO-approved FISA assessments, through the e-learning platform.